Effective: 17 March 2026

LATIN AMERICAN SPACE CHALLENGE

LASC General Rules (LGR)

Space Challenge

Edition 1 | Revision 1

The electronic version is the official, approved document.
Ensure you are using the correct version before proceeding.

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LATIN AMERICAN SPACE CHALLENGE

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Record of Revisions

The LASC General Rules (LGR) document was created to consolidate team organization requirements into a single reference. As a result, the rules and requirements related to team and mission organization are now contained in this document.

The table below records all revisions of this document since the first Latin American Space Challenge.

Edition Number	Revision Number	Issue Date	Effective Date
1	1	March 2026	March 2026

LGR First Edition

The following table describes changes contained in Edition 1 of the LASC General Rules (LGR). The table describes significant changes and individual changes in each of the LGR sections and provisions.

LGR 1 Revision 1 Highlights	
Area(s) of Change	**Description(s)**
All Document.	New document.

Introduction

Purpose

The Latin American Space Challenge (LASC) General Rules (LGR) establish the rules, requirements, and guidelines necessary for teams to effectively participate in the event's challenges.

This document serves as the primary reference for teams throughout the Application and Registration Process and during event participation, defining the criteria, procedures, and practices to be followed.

The LGR provides the overarching framework for team organization and mission development, enabling participants to align with established best practices in safety, quality, and mission planning.

Manual Revisions

The document is subject to an annual revision, which invariably leads to a new edition. In the event that critical issues emerge impacting the content of the document, a revision to the current edition will be undertaken. All changes in this document are listed in the revision highlights table. For easier orientation, the following symbols identify any changes made within each section:

- △ Addition of a new item.
- ↻ Change to an item.
- ⊗ Deletion of an item.

Section 1 — Safety (SAF)

Section 1 details the Safety (SAF) policies, procedures, and processes required for all teams, missions, and members to ensure event safety. This section states our Safety Policy.

1.1. Safety Policy

Safety is our Value number 1.

The Safety Management System (SMS) of the Latin American Space Challenge is composed of four pillars: Safety Policy, Safety Risk Management, Safety Assurance, and Safety Promotion.

All team members shall report any observed unsafe activities to event officials. The event will provide a specific channel for these reports, which will be anonymized before any potential action is taken by event officials.

The event will be guided by a Just Culture approach, where errors will be addressed through reeducation. However, any violation of rules will be treated as potential unruly behavior, with penalties or disqualification possible as outlined in Section 2.

During the Launch Readiness Review (LRR), event officials will use a checklist to approve an experimental rocket for loading with energetics and a rocket motor. Ensuring safety will be a key process for issuing any Flight Card during the event.

Event officials will conduct a safety risk management analysis before each launch to reduce the potential probabilities and/or severities of any operational risks.

Promotion is key to raising the bar among all participating teams. Event officials will conduct safety briefings to increase overall public awareness. Launching an experimental rocket is not trivial; the event has associated risks. All participants shall understand and accept these risks by signing a Waiver and Release of Liability to participate.

ORG 1.1.1. All participants shall follow the Latin American Space Challenge Safety Policy.

Section 2 — Documentation System (DOC)

Section 2 details the LASC Documentation System (DOC) policies, procedures, and processes required for all teams, missions, and members to ensure the proper organization of the entry application, team and mission management, and compliance with the general rules of the event.

2.1. Official Languages

English, Portuguese and Spanish are the official languages of the Latin American Space Challenge; documents comprising the LASC Documentation System are written in International English in accordance with the official policy.

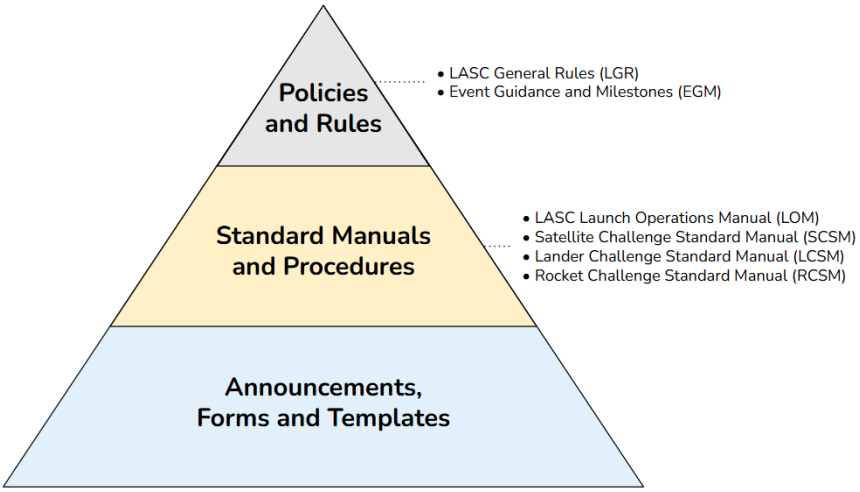
ORG 2.1.1. All documents, including reports, presentation materials, and correspondence with event officials shall be in English. For oral presentations, including videos and on-site presentations, speakers have the flexibility to choose from any of the event's official languages.

2.2. Documentation System

The LASC Documentation System is structured into three hierarchical levels of documents that establish the overall framework of the event and its challenges. Adherence to this documentation system by teams and participants is mandatory to ensure safety and compliance. In the event of any conflict or inconsistency, higher-level documents shall prevail over lower-level documents.

The system comprises: (1) Policies and Rules; (2) Standard Manuals and Procedures; and (3) Announcements, Forms, and Templates.

Figure 1: LASC Documentation System.



All documents within the LASC Documentation System are made publicly available in a timely manner. Documents and forms referenced in this manual can be accessed and downloaded from the LASC website (www.lasc.space).

Depending on the objective and purpose of each document, LASC Standards and Recommended Practices (LSARPs) are provided to support participants in identifying mandatory and recommended requirements.

ORG 2.2.1. All participants shall regularly access the LASC website (www.lasc.space) to review the most current versions of all applicable documents. Downloading documents for local use is discouraged, as revisions may occur periodically. The use of outdated versions of LASC documentation is not permitted and may result in penalties.

2.3. LASC Standards and Recommended Practices (LSARPs)

The specifications and standards outlined in reputable aerospace guidelines and industry best practices form the primary sources for the LASC Standards and Recommended Practices (LSARPs). These encompass a wide range of criteria, extending to various aspects of rocket design, engineering, and operational management.

The LSARPs draw upon established principles from recognized aerospace entities, technical publications, and regulatory frameworks relevant to space engineering and mission planning.

The sources of reference and benchmarking includes, but are not limited to the Intercollegiate Rocket Engineering Competition (IREC) or Spaceport America Cup (SA Cup), the European Rocketry Challenge (EuRoC), Friends of Amateur Rocketry - Oxidizers Uninhibited Tournament (FAR-OUT), the Launch Canada Challenge, the IATA Operational Safety Audit (IOSA) program, the Manual de Segurança e Boas Práticas para Operação e Lançamento de Foguetes Amadores by the Brazilian Space Agency (AEB), and the NASA System Safety Handbook.

Explanation of LSARPs

LSARPs in this manual are designed for use within the Latin American Space Challenge (LASC) and provide the criteria for evaluations. LSARPs are not regulations.

LSARPs Identifiers

All provisions (i. e. the LSARPs) are marked with an identifier consisting of a three-letter section abbreviation and a series of three numbers separated by two decimal points (e.g., ORG 1.1.1).

Maintaining stable LSARPs identifiers is crucial for user convenience among teams, mission, judges, and others, and for maintaining accurate statistical data. Therefore, efforts are made to minimize renumbering of LSARPs when revising the documentation.

Standards

LASC Standards are specified systems, policies, programs, processes, procedures, plans, sets of measures, components, types of equipment or any other aspect under the scope of LASC that have been determined to be a necessity, and with which a team will be expected to be in conformity during the evaluation process.

Standards always contain the words "**shall**" or "**must**" (e.g., "The team shall have a process…" or "Each mission must include…") to indicate that conformance by a team and/or mission under evaluation is mandatory for all space challenges.

Recommended Practices

LASC Recommended Practices are specified systems, policies, programs, processes, procedures, plans, sets of measures, components, types of equipment or any other aspects under the scope of LASC that have been determined to be desirable, but conformance is optional by a team and/or a mission.

Recommended Practices always contain the word "**should**" (e.g., "The team should have a policy…") to denote conformance is optional.

Conditional Phrase

Certain provisions (i.e., standards or recommended practices, or sub-specifications within certain provisions), begin with a conditional phrase. The conditional phrase states the conditions (one or more) that serve to define the applicability of the provision or sub-specification to the team and/or mission being evaluated. A conditional phrase begins with the words "If the team…"

When assessing a team against a provision or sub-specification that begins with a conditional phrase, the Judge will first determine if a team meets the condition(s) stated in the conditional phrase. If the team and/or mission meets the stated condition(s), the provision is applicable to the team and shall be assessed for conformance. If the team does not meet the condition(s), the provision or specification is not applicable, and such non-applicability will then be recorded as N/A.

Section 3 — Team Organization (ORG)

Section 2 defines the Team Organization (ORG) addressing the organization and management system of a team for the purpose of ensuring conformity with all provisions of the event.

3.1. Team Composition and Eligibility

The Latin American Space Challenge allows teams to submit multiple missions across different challenges and categories. The organization of each team and its assigned missions forms the foundation for the successful execution of every selected mission. The following sections outline the minimum required composition, organizational structure, and eligibility criteria.

Team Composition

ORG 3.1.1. Teams may be composed of:

- Student members: Individuals currently enrolled in high school, technical school, a bachelor's, or a master's degree program, as well as those who were officially enrolled during the previous academic year (e.g., recent graduates who completed their studies shortly before the event are still eligible);
- Non-student members: Individuals such as enthusiasts, researchers, startup members, amateurs, and hobbyists; or
- Mixed: A combination of student and non-student members.

ORG 3.1.2. There is no maximum limit on the total number of members per team. However, each team shall have a minimum of four (4) enrolled members, corresponding to the minimum structure required for a mission. Each individual shall participate in only one team.

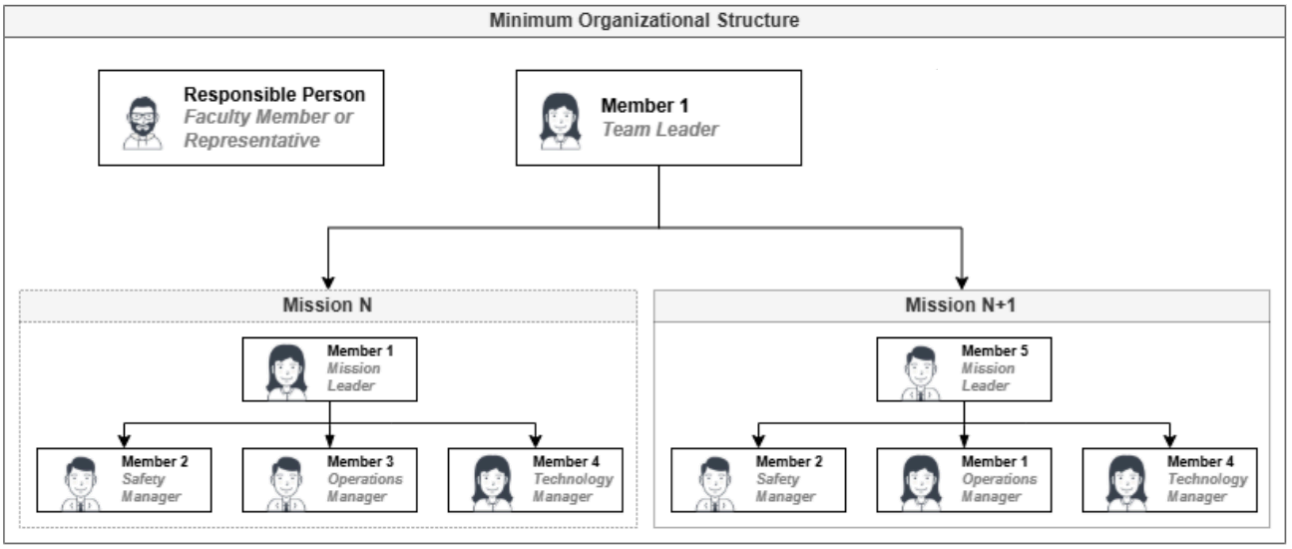
ORG 3.1.3. Each team must designate a Team Leader during the Application and Registration Process. Additionally, each mission must have a designated Mission Leader. The same individual may serve as both the Team Leader and the Mission Leader.

ORG 3.1.4. Each team shall designate a Responsible Person who shall be legally accountable for the team and all its members, including any actions, omissions, or incidents arising from the team's activities. The Responsible Person shall be identified in the Institutional Participation Letter described in Section 2.4 and may serve as its signatory.

This individual shall be liable, in accordance with Brazilian legislation, including but not limited to the Código Civil Brasileiro (Lei nº 10.406/2002) and the Código Penal Brasileiro (Decreto-Lei nº 2.848/1940), for any damages to persons, property, or the environment, as well as for any injuries or incidents resulting from negligence, imprudence, or malpractice.

The Responsible Person must be at least 18 (eighteen) years old and must formally acknowledge their role by signing a Term of Responsibility to be submitted timely before the on-site event.

Figure 2: Example of a Minimum Team Organizational Structure.



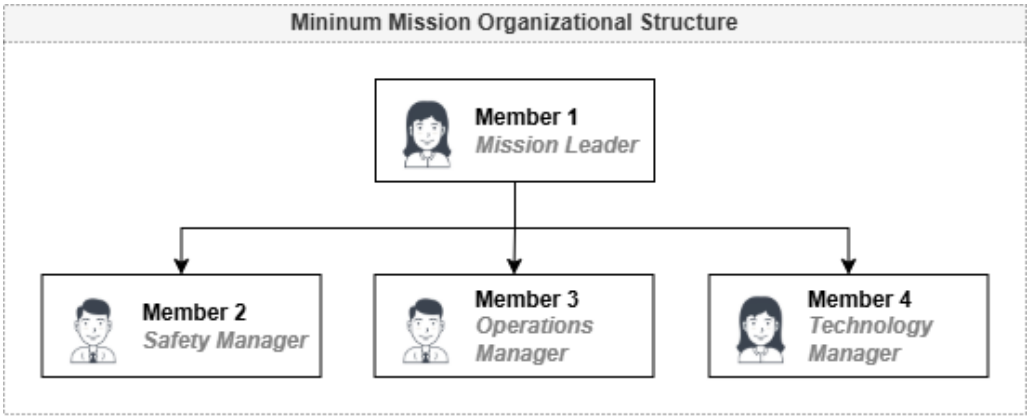
ORG 3.1.5. Teams composed of individuals under eighteen (18) years of age shall submit a signed authorization from their parents and/or legal guardians on or before the Mission Report submission deadline. Teams with minors who are not legally authorized to participate shall be excluded from the event.

Mission Structure

The Latin American Space Challenge comprises three challenges, each with distinct categories. Teams shall submit a separate Entry Application Form for each mission in order to be considered in the Application and Registration Process as described in Section 3. The relationship between each team and the event organization is established through its selected missions.

ORG 3.1.6. Each mission within a team shall establish an organizational structure that includes, at a minimum, the following positions: Mission Leader, Safety Manager, Operations Manager, and Technology Manager. Descriptions and responsibilities are provided in Appendix A.

Figure 3: Minimum Mission Organizational Structure Required.



ORG 3.1.7. Each required position within a mission shall be assigned to a distinct individual to ensure clear distribution of responsibilities and accountability. An individual may hold required positions across multiple missions; however, no individual shall hold more than one required position within the same mission

ORG 3.1.8. For missions submitted to the Rocket Challenge, the assignment of a Rocketry Mentor (RM) may be required. The conditions under which a Rocketry Mentor is mandatory are defined in Section 3.2.

3.2. Rocketry Mentor (RM)

Teams with selected missions in the Rocket Challenge and/or Lander Challenge are encouraged to have an experienced Rocketry Mentor (RM) assisting the mission development and, mainly, advising on safety procedures. The RM is not required to be onsite during the launch activities.

ORG 3.2.1. Each team should designate a Rocketry Mentor for each Selected Mission. This is particularly mandatory for new teams that have not previously participated in the Latin American Space Challenge or for teams selected to participate in a mission category that involves hybrid or liquid rocket propulsion systems.

The RM will follow the team's progress throughout its developments and make recommendations and/or modifications on the project in order to guarantee safety and increase chances of a successful launch.

ORG 3.2.2. Each selected mission should register a RM by the deadline defined in the LASC Event Guidance and Milestones (EGM) document. Event officials will contact the RM to confirm their information and verify their acceptance to serve as the mission's mentor.

ORG 3.2.3. The same RM may be designated by different teams for up to three (3) selected missions.

ORG 3.2.4. The RM shall be an engineer with proven experience in the space or defense sector, or an engineer who has previously participated in the Latin American Space Challenge.

This requirement ensures that the mentor has the necessary expertise and a solid understanding of the mission's dynamics and associated risks. LASC reserves the right to reject the proposed Rocketry Mentor at its sole discretion and without the need for justification.

3.3. Foreign Teams and Seeking a Visa

For many foreign teams we have seen before, it is important to seek a visa upon acceptance. Keep in mind that some members of your team may not be citizens of the country where your university is located. Therefore, upon acceptance into the challenge, file for your visas immediately.

If an individual on your team is from a country that has difficulties acquiring a visa, be sure to cross-train replacements in case they are unable to attend the challenge. Ensure that all necessary paperwork is submitted promptly so that team members can attend the competition in person, rather than as a photo affixed to their control panel.

ORG 3.3.1. Each foreign team with at least one selected mission shall contact event officials on or before submitting Progress Update 1 to request a Letter of Invitation. The mission leader shall provide a list of full names, passport numbers, email addresses, and mobile numbers of all team members seeking a visa to Brazil.

3.4. Institutional Participation Letter

The Latin American Space Challenge requires that every participating team, regardless of the number of missions or challenges they enter, shall show an affiliation with an academic institution, a company, or an accountable individual who is over the Brazilian legal age of 18. This accountable party shall sign a letter accepting full responsibility for the team members, projects and all activities related to their participation in the event.

Institutions sending more than one team to the LASC need only to write one participation letter, covering all their teams, but each included team shall submit an individual copy of that letter.

ORG 3.4.1. All teams shall timely send a digital PDF copy of the letter signed by a representative of the institution or responsible individual, acknowledging full responsibility for the team. The signatory shall be a senior faculty member (i.e., professor) or a senior representative of the team (i.e., aerospace/aeronautical or mechanical engineer).

3.5. Participant Agreement

All participants shall sign the LASC Participant Agreement (Waiver and Release of Liability), without exception.

To the extent permitted by applicable law, each team shall indemnify and hold harmless LASC and its event officials from and against any and all claims, demands, actions, liabilities, damages, losses, or expenses (including, but not limited to, monetary loss, property damage, personal injury, or wrongful death), whether asserted by an individual or entity, or arising from judicial or administrative proceedings at any governmental level, resulting from any acts, omissions, negligence, or willful misconduct by the team, its affiliated institution, or their respective officers, members, employees, agents, contractors, invitees, or volunteers. This includes, without limitation, the payment of any penalties, fines, awards, fees, and related costs or expenses.

ORG 3.5.1. All individuals attending the event, including team members, faculty advisors, and any other participants, shall sign the LASC Participant Agreement. Individuals who fail to sign the agreement shall not be permitted to participate in any activities at the Sugarcane Launch Range (SLR) or access event facilities.

ORG 3.5.2. The LASC Participant Agreement will be sent by e-mail to all officially registered participants after the payment of the Rocketeer/Satelliteer Ticket, but before the submission of the Mission Report, and shall be digitally signed.

ORG 3.5.3. If a registered participant fails to sign the LASC Participant Agreement online before the deadline, all missions associated with that team member will be subject to penalties. Although penalties may apply, there will be a final opportunity to sign the agreement during the check-in session.

Participants attending competition who do not sign this waiver will not be permitted to enter the event facilities.

3.6. Insurance

The organization of the event will not be responsible or pay for any accidents, damaged property, and injuries related to the event and caused by selected mission; including if a team's activity damages a person or property. Also, if the person or property owner decides to sue the team, the event's policy does not protect the team from the additional lawsuit.

ORG 3.6.1. All teams should obtain and provide a proof of insurance coverage for all attending members prior to attending the Latin American Space Challenge. Note: individual, personal, or travel insurance policies do not qualify under this position. LASC is not responsible for and cannot assist in finding suitable insurance policies.

3.7. Unruly Behavior, Disqualification, Withdrawal

Penalties for Unsafe or Unsportsmanlike Conduct

Unsafe conduct includes, but is not limited to, violating any of the established principles stated on LASC Documents, failure to use checklists during operations, violating motor vehicle traffic safety rules, and failure to use appropriate personal protective equipment.

ORG 3.7.1. Team Conduct It is the responsibility of every Mission Leader and Safety Manager to ensure that their team conducts themselves in a safe and professional manner. There is a list of point deductions per occurrence that is set prior to the competition for various types of infraction, ranging from not clearing an area in time when a salvo is announced to providing false information on a report.

Unsportsmanlike conduct also includes, but is not limited to, hostility shown towards any LASC participant and officials, intentional misrepresentation of facts to any competition official, intentional failure to comply with any reasonable instruction given by an event official.

ORG 3.7.2. Teams will be penalized for every instance of unsafe or unsportsmanlike conduct recorded by event officials depending on the severity of the incident.

Disqualification

A number of criteria constitute grounds for disqualification from consideration for any award and continuation at the event. These can include a failure to meet the defining mission requirements, failure to submit any document and failure to send eligible team members to the onsite event.

Substance abuse and intoxication (or after-effects thereof) during the event and purposeful endangering behaviors severely compromising the safety of LASC and respective participants will make the entire team immediately and without further warning, eligible for expulsion from the LASC event in disgrace. If one or more members of a team fails to be utterly sober and clear-headed, this is regarded as outright contempt of the LASC spirit and safety guidelines. The consequence is the immediate and irrevocable removal of the team from the LASC event.

ORG 3.7.3. Event officials reserve the right to assess any misconduct/mismanagement case by case and to take the necessary proper actions leading to penalties or disqualification of specific team members, mission or the the entire team.

3.8. Mission Withdrawal

ORG 3.8.1. Teams that decide to formally withdraw a mission from the Space Challenge at any time prior to the event shall send an e-mail entitled “Mission *Your Mission ID* Formally Withdraws From The Event Edition LASC'' to lasc@lasc.space.

For example, a team with a mission assigned the Mission ID "19" would withdraw from the 7th LASC by sending an e-mail entitled “Mission 19 Formally Withdraws from the 7th LASC''.

Section 4 — Application and Registration Process (REG)

Section 4 defines the Application and Registration Process (REG), including the procedures, requirements, and timelines for the submission of mission proposals, as well as the evaluation, selection, and registration of participating teams and their respective missions.

4.1. Entry Application Process

ORG 4.1.1. Teams intending to participate in any challenge shall submit a complete Entry Application Form for each mission category in which they intend to participate, using the form available on the LASC website during the period defined by the event officials. Late submissions shall not be accepted.

Submission Limitations

ORG 41.2. Each team may submit multiple missions across different challenges and categories. However, no more than three (3) missions per team shall be selected in total by the event officials.

ORG 4.1.3. A team shall not have more than one selected mission within the same category of a given challenge.

As a result, no team may compete in the same category more than once. The event officials will monitor and assess each project independently, regardless of shared student membership or academic affiliation. For example, Team ABC may register a project for the 1 km AGL apogee with hybrid/liquid propulsion system category and another experimental rocket project for the 0.5 km AGL apogee project.

Entry Application Form and Announcement of Selected Missions

The Entry Application Form is made available on the LASC website during the application period, as defined in the LASC Event Guidance and Milestones (EGM) document. No payment is required at the time of submission.

ORG 4.1.4. Total completeness of the Entry Form is required, including information specified on Section 3 of this document.

Selected Missions (Tier 1 and Tier 2) will be announced on the LASC website following the application deadline, through the publication of an official Mission ID list.

Mission Identification Number

All selected missions shall be assigned a unique Mission Identification Number (Mission ID) for identification and tracking purposes. Mission IDs are assigned independently of team

identification, and no direct association between teams and Mission ID numbering shall be inferred.

Missions participating in the Rocket Challenge shall be assigned Mission IDs ranging from 001 to 199. Missions participating in the Satellite Challenge shall be assigned Mission IDs ranging from 201 to 399, and missions participating in the Lander Challenge shall be assigned Mission IDs ranging from 401 to 600.

The Mission ID serves as the primary reference for all official identification and tracking of missions by the event organization.

ORG 4.1.5. A correspondence between a team with a selected mission and event officials shall contain the respective Mission's ID number to enable a more timely and accurate response.

4.2. Mission Selection Process

While the event officials aim to admit all applicants, a formal selection process is required to ensure the safe and effective management of team participation. The selection process is not conducted on a first-come, first-served basis; all applications submitted within the designated application period are evaluated on equal terms.

The Application and Registration Process is governed by the LASC Mission Selection Process, which is based on the availability of operational slots.

Slots are limited and may be affected by external constraints, including, but not limited to, capacity limits within each challenge, infrastructure constraints, and adverse weather conditions. Accordingly, event officials select a predetermined number of missions based on criteria established to ensure safety and maximize the overall quality of the event.

Selection criteria include, but are not limited to, compliance with applicable documentation, the quality and objectives of the proposed mission, the level of technological development and innovation, and the team's experience and demonstrated maturity in past events.

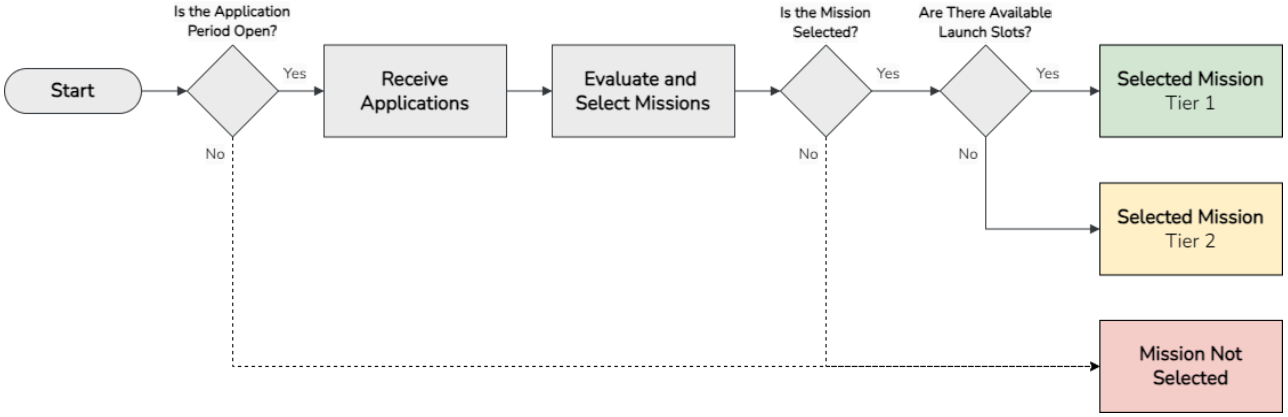
Given the historically high volume of applications, teams should be prepared for the possibility that their missions may not be selected. Due to the limited number of available slots, selected missions are classified as Tier 1 or Tier 2.

- Tier 1 Selected Missions will be assigned and reserved a launch slot during the onsite event in compliance with the rules outlined in Section 3 of this document.

- Tier 2 Selected Missions will not have guaranteed slots during the onsite event. However, they may be allocated vacant or newly available slots during operations.

In addition, throughout the delivery roadmap, if a Tier 1 Selected Mission withdraws, an appropriate Level 2 Selected Mission will be escalated as a Tier 1 Selected Mission.

Figure 1: Mission Selection Process.



Regardless of the outcome, all teams will be notified about the results of the selection process, including feedback on their submissions up to 90 (ninety) days after the closing of the applications.

It is important to note that submissions received after the application deadline will not be considered under any circumstances.

Section 5 — Awards (AWA)

Section 5 defines the Overall Awards and Challenge Awards of the Latin American Space Challenge, including the general rules for scoring and evaluation, the scoreboard structure, and the high-level criteria for the allocation of Overall Awards.

5.1. Scores and Scoreboard

Scores and grading criteria are defined in the respective challenge standard manuals, according to the objectives, purpose, and specificities of each challenge.

Scoreboard

After each appropriate milestone, event officials will publish a partial scoreboard for all mission categories. The partial scoreboard will be available on the LASC's MissionForge Platform and will be updated after the evaluation of each selected mission. The MissionForge Platform will be available for participants of selected missions after the first progress update.

Event officials will document the evaluations using individual score sheets for each selected mission and then consolidate them into one master scoreboard using the grading criteria set out in the following subsections.

Up to seven days after the Award Ceremony, individual scoring sheets and feedback regarding the strengths and weaknesses of each selected mission's performance will be provided by email if requested.

Handling of Questions & Complaints Regarding Scoring

Teams are welcome to approach the officials to ask for specific, non-binding, oral feedback regarding their perception of the teams' work during all points of the competition to provide the teams with an opportunity to learn and improve.

In the case the teams have more detailed questions or specific complaints regarding the scoring after the scoring has been announced, such as they would like to receive elaborate feedback on a particular aspect of the score for clarification, e.g., to improve upon for the next event, or if they identify an honest mistake made by the jury, the following process applies:

ORG 5.1.2. Only the mission leader can submit a written feedback request once to lasc@lasc.space. Submissions of the feedback are accepted until no later than one week (7 days) after official announcement of the score. To keep the workload on the officials to a reasonable amount, teams are asked to limit their questions plus complaints to 3 (three) in total. Event officials will then review these three questions and/or complaints and provide written feedback.

If an honest mistake in scoring is apparent, event officials will review the score provided to the team and decide on a case-by-case basis if and how to account for this, especially and only if this would significantly affect the overall score and placement of the team.

It should be noted that teams are expected not to abuse this possibility of questions and complaints. Officers will not participate in a discussion questioning the evaluation's reasoning on the score given.

5.2. Overall Awards

The Latin American Space Challenge grants both Overall Awards and Challenge Awards. Overall Awards recognize achievements across the event as a whole, while Challenge Awards are specific to each challenge: Rocket Challenge, Satellite Challenge, and Lander Challenge. Awards are presented during the Award Ceremony.

The Overall Awards include: the João B. G. Canalle Award for Technical Excellence; the Rick Maschek Engineering Award for Innovation; the Valentina V. Tereshkova Award for Women Representation and Diversity; the Team Conduct Award; the Team Sportsmanship Award; and the Team Spirit Award.

Award Ceremony

ORG 5.2.1. The Award Ceremony, to be held on the last day of the event, will be the final milestone of LASC where winners will be announced. All teams shall be present during the Awards Ceremony. If an award-winning team is absent, event officials have the right to select the subsequent team to receive the award. This ensures that recognition is given and accepted in person at the ceremony.

João B. G. Canalle Award for Technical Excellence

The João B. G. Canalle Award for Technical Excellence is a Technical Achievement Award that recognizes a team which demonstrates exceptional overall engineering discipline and technical skill through their analyses and conclusions, project or program planning and execution, operational procedure, manufacturing processes, iterative improvement, systems engineering methodology, robust design, etc. Any team with a selected mission is eligible for the João B. G. Canalle Award for Technical Excellence, although it should have submitted Presentation Session Materials and a high-quality Mission Report.

Rick Maschek Engineering Award for Innovation

The Rick Maschek Engineering Award for Innovation is a is a Technical Achievement Award that recognizes a team whose selected mission includes one or more features (including analytic or operational processes as well as components or assemblies) the judging panel finds genuinely "novel", "inventive", or solving a unique problem identified by the team.

Any team with a selected mission is eligible for the Rick Maschek Engineering Award for Innovation, although it should have submitted Presentation Session Materials and a high-quality Mission Report.

Valentina V. Tereshkova Award for Women Representation and Diversity

The Valentina V. Tereshkova Award for Women Representation and Diversity recognizes a team whose members composition has a substantial percentage of women and diversity. It also recognizes teams who have women and diversity in prominent positions, such as mission leaders. Any team with a selected mission is eligible for the Valentina V. Tereshkova Award for Women Representation and Diversity, although it shall have submitted a high-quality Mission Report.

Team Conduct Award

The Team Conduct Award recognizes a team whose conduct throughout the Latin American Space Challenge is exemplary of goals and ideals held by the event organizers. The Latin American Space Challenge should be an event where academia, industry, and the public may come together to preserve, popularize, and advance space science in a collaborative environment energized by friendly competition. The Team Conduct Award will be awarded to a single team chosen by the event officials participating in any challenge.

Team Sportsmanship Award

The Team Sportsmanship Award recognizes a team which goes above and beyond to assist their fellow teams and the organizers assure the event is a safe, productive, and enjoyable experience for all involved. They may do this in many ways, such as making themselves available to lend-a-hand whenever and however they can (whether they are asked to or not), being positive role models for their fellow teams, and generally being a "force for good" in every activity in which they involve themselves. The Team Sportsmanship Award will be awarded to a single team chosen by the event officials participating in any challenge..

Team Spirit Award

The Team Spirit Award recognizes a team that has displayed an outstanding effort as working as a unit towards a common goal, by being exceptionally organized, reliable, and prepared in all aspects of the competition, be it deliverables, communication, or operation, and goes above and beyond to display a great sense of team spirit and sportsmanship. The Team Spirit Award will be awarded to a single team chosen by the event officials participating in any challenge.

5.2. Challenge Awards

The Latin American Space Challenge awards First Place and Second Place in each Mission Category within each Challenge, as well as Overall Winners for each Challenge.

Appendix A: Role Description

This appendix provides detailed role descriptions to support the effective organization of teams and their mission structures. It aims to guide task delegation, planning, and team coordination, helping ensure successful participation in the Latin American Space Challenge.

Role Description and Key Responsibilities

Team Leader

- Serve as the primary point of contact between the team and the LASC Organization for all administrative and non-technical matters.
- Oversee the entire application and registration process for the team.
- Ensure accurate and timely submission of all required team documentation.
- Manage team logistics, including coordination of travel, lodging, and on-site support.
- Handle communications related to event fees, deadlines, and administrative compliance.
- Coordinate with Mission Leaders to ensure alignment and readiness across all missions within the team.

Mission Leader

- Act as the primary liaison between the LASC Organization and the mission team for all mission-related topics.
- Manage and oversee all technical and non-technical aspects of the assigned mission.
- Ensure all deliverables, documentation, and technical reports are timely submitted.
- Coordinate with Safety, Operations, and Technology Managers to maintain mission readiness.
- Represent the mission in all technical discussions and reviews conducted by LASC officials.
- Initiate and handle all official communications with the LASC Organization regarding the mission.

Safety Manager

- Ensure that the mission complies with the LASC Safety Policy throughout the entire project lifecycle, including design, development, testing, and on-site operations.
- Lead the creation and maintenance of the Failure Modes and Effects Analysis (FMEA) and comprehensive Risk Assessments for the mission.
- Monitor and mitigate potential hazards during mission development and testing phases.
- Act as the mission's primary authority on safety-related matters and procedures.
- Support the team in identifying, documenting, and responding to potential nonconformities during the on-site event.
- Participate in the mission's safety reviews and ensure compliance with all applicable safety standards.

Operations Manager

- Oversee and execute integrated testing and operational procedures for all components and systems of the experimental rocket.
- Ensure all applicable Latin American Space Challenge Rules and Policies (LSARPs) are correctly implemented in the vehicle.
- Serve as the primary point of contact for the LASC Launch Director and Operations Control staff during the on-site event.
- Coordinate and lead all mission activities related to the Launch Readiness Review (LRR) process.
- Ensure that the mission team is prepared and present to utilize its designated launch slot effectively and without delay.
- Support the Mission Leader in managing the schedule and logistics associated with launch operations.

Technology Manager

- Ensure full compliance with all applicable Latin American Space Challenge Rules and Policies (LSARPs); develop and implement necessary technical features in the vehicle as required.
- Guarantee that the vehicle and its components meet the minimum performance standards for testing and launch operations.
- Prepare all materials required for the Presentation Session; responsible for the presentation if the mission is selected, in accordance with current rules.